Teardown #2

Interview context

After interviewing gym-goer Y, I chose gym machine QR codes for a hands-on teardown. Y used machine QR codes when unsure how to use equipment and initially trusted the manufacturer's instructions, but gradually stopped relying on them.

My gym machine QR code teardown

Scanning the QR code

I tested the QR code on a Life Fitness bicep curl machine. Scanning it opened a short instructional video showing how to set up the machine and perform the exercise. The video loaded, but its quality was low, and I was prompted to sign in to an account.

Instructions and use

The video helped me understand the machine setup, where to position my arms, and the basic movement. However, the explanation was brief and did not provide many specific examples or detailed form cues.

Pricing and access

I did not see a separate charge for the video. In my experience, access involved a gym membership account. I would need to verify whether that sign-in requirement applies to every Life Fitness QR-code tutorial.

Points of hesitation

- **Video quality:** The demonstration was low quality, which made the instructions less clear.
- **Limited detail:** The tutorial covered basic setup and movement but lacked more specific explanations.
- **Access:** I was asked to sign in, which could be inconvenient for someone trying equipment without an existing account.
- **Representation:** The demonstration featured a man; I wondered whether users such as teens or women might prefer a wider range of demonstrators.

Strengths, gaps, and Formly implication

Strengths: The QR code gave me a quick way to learn the machine setup, arm positioning, and basic exercise movement.

Gaps: The video quality was low, the instructions were not detailed, and I encountered a sign-in prompt. The tutorial showed a movement, but I did not observe it assessing my own form.

Formly implication: I would like to explore adding instructional videos or QR-code access to exercise help in the future. It may also be useful to test whether users benefit from demonstrations featuring different people. These are ideas to investigate, not findings about what users need.